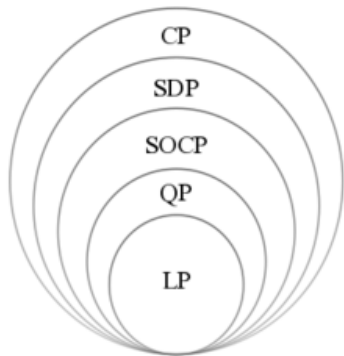
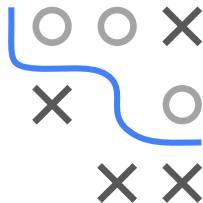


Optimization in Machine Learning

Constrained Optimization

Linear Programming



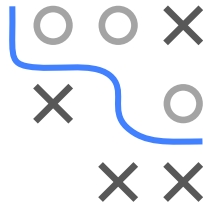
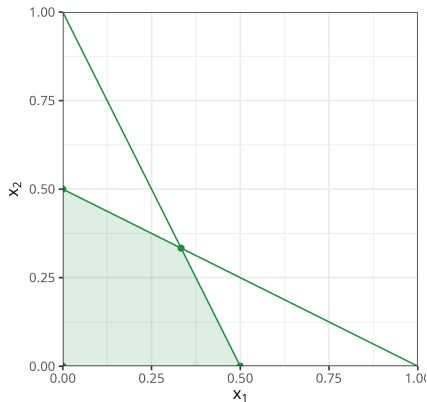
Learning goals

- Instances of LPs underlying statistical estimation
- Definition of an LP
- Geometric intuition of LPs

LINEAR PROGRAMMING

- **Linear problems (LP):** linear objective + linear constraints
- **Example:**

$$\min -x_1 - x_2 \quad \text{s.t. } x_1 + 2x_2 \leq 1, \quad 2x_1 + x_2 \leq 1, \quad x_1, x_2 \geq 0$$



LP EXAMPLES: QUANTILE REGRESSION

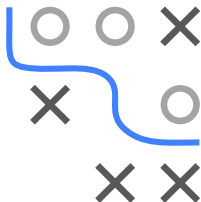
- (Sparse) Quantile regression:

$$\min_{\beta_0, \beta} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \rho_{\tau} \left(y^{(i)} - \beta_0 - \beta^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} \right) \quad \text{s.t. } \|\beta\|_1 \leq t$$

where $\beta_0 \in \mathbb{R}$ and $\beta \in \mathbb{R}^p$ are coefficients, and $\rho_{\tau}, \tau \in [0, 1]$, is the check function:

$$\rho_{\tau}(s) = \begin{cases} \tau \cdot s & \text{if } s > 0, \\ -(1 - \tau) \cdot s & \text{if } s \leq 0. \end{cases}$$

- **Case** $\tau = 1/2$: Median regression (a.k.a. least absolute errors (LAE), least absolute deviations (LAD))
- Parameter $t \geq 0$ determines regularization



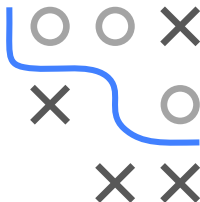
LP EXAMPLES: DANTZIG SELECTOR

- **Dantzig selector:**

$$\min_{\beta \in \mathbb{R}^p} \|\beta\|_1 \quad \text{s.t.} \quad \|\mathbf{X}^T(\mathbf{X}\beta - \mathbf{y})\|_\infty \leq \lambda$$

where $\mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{R}^n$, $\mathbf{X} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times p}$, and $\lambda > 0$ is a tuning parameter

- The infinity norm is defined as $\|x\|_\infty = \max\{|x_1|, \dots, |x_n|\}$
- Similar to (and behaves similar to) the Lasso
- Introduced for variable selection by Tao and Candès
- Details about LPs in statistical estimation: see [► PhD thesis of Yonggong Gao](#)



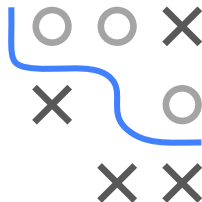
LP: STANDARD FORM

- LPs can be formulated in **standard form**:

$$\max_{\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n} \mathbf{c}^T \mathbf{x} \quad \text{s.t. } \mathbf{Ax} \leq \mathbf{b}, \mathbf{x} \geq 0$$

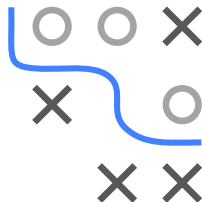
with $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$, $\mathbf{b} \in \mathbb{R}^m$

- Constraints are to be understood **componentwise**
- $\mathbf{x} \geq 0$: “non-negativity constraint”
- $\mathbf{c}$: “cost vector”



LP: CONVERTING TO STANDARD FORM

- $\min \longleftrightarrow \max$: multiply objective function by -1
- $\leq \longleftrightarrow \geq$: multiply inequality by -1
- $= \longleftrightarrow \leq, \geq$: replace $\mathbf{a}_i^T \mathbf{x} = b_i$ by $\mathbf{a}_i^T \mathbf{x} \geq b_i$ and $\mathbf{a}_i^T \mathbf{x} \leq b_i$
- No non-negativity constraint: replace x_i by $x_i^+ - x_i^-$ with $x_i^+, x_i^- \geq 0$ (positive and negative part)



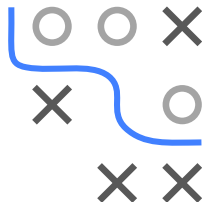
LP: STANDARD FORM EXAMPLE

- Example:

$$\min -x_1 - x_2 \quad \text{s.t. } x_1 + 2x_2 \leq 1, \quad 2x_1 + x_2 \leq 1, \quad x_1, x_2 \geq 0$$

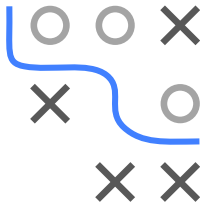
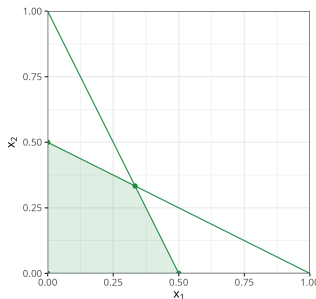
- Can also be formulated as:

$$\max(1, 1) \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{s.t. } \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{x} \leq \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{x} \geq 0$$



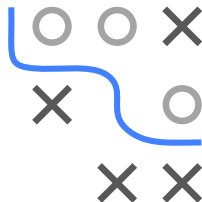
GEOMETRIC INTERPRETATION: FEASIBLE SET

- i -th inequality constraint: $\mathbf{a}_i^T \mathbf{x} \leq b_i$
- Points $\{\mathbf{x} : \mathbf{a}_i^T \mathbf{x} = b_i\}$ form a hyperplane in $\mathbb{R}^n$
($\mathbf{a}_i$ is perpendicular to the hyperplane and called **normal vector**)
- Points $\{\mathbf{x} : \mathbf{a}_i^T \mathbf{x} \geq b_i\}$ lie on the side of the hyperplane into which the normal vector points (“half-space”)
- Each inequality divides the space into two halves
- **Claim:** Points satisfying **all** inequalities form a **convex polytope**

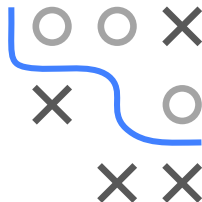


GEOMETRIC INTERPRETATION: POLYTOPES

- A **polytope** is a generalized polygon in arbitrary dimensions
- A polytope consists of several sub-polytopes:
 - 0-polytope: point
 - 1-polytope: line
 - 2-polytope: polygon, ...
- **General:**
 - d -polytope is formed from several $(d - 1)$ -polytopes ("facets")
 - $(d - 1)$ -polytope is formed from several $(d - 2)$ -polytopes



GEOMETRIC INTERPRETATION: CONVEXITY



- Points $\{\mathbf{x} : \mathbf{a}_i^T \mathbf{x} = b_i\}$ lie on the boundary of the polytope

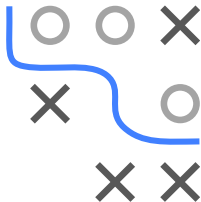
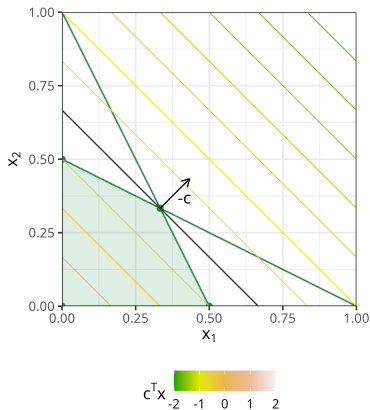
- Polytope $\{\mathbf{x} : \mathbf{Ax} \leq \mathbf{b}\}$ is convex: For $\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2 \in \mathcal{S}$ and $t \in [0, 1]$

$$\mathbf{A}(\mathbf{x}_1 + t(\mathbf{x}_2 - \mathbf{x}_1)) = \mathbf{Ax}_1 + t(\mathbf{Ax}_2 - \mathbf{Ax}_1) = (1-t) \underbrace{\mathbf{Ax}_1}_{\leq \mathbf{b}} + t \underbrace{\mathbf{Ax}_2}_{\leq \mathbf{b}} \leq (1-t)\mathbf{b} + t\mathbf{b} = \mathbf{b}$$

- Polytope $\{\mathbf{x} : \mathbf{Ax} \leq \mathbf{b}\}$ is an n -**simplex**, i.e., convex hull of $n + 1$ *affinely independent* points

GEOMETRIC INTERPRETATION: OBJECTIVE FUNCTION

- **Linear case:** Contour lines form a hyperplane
- **Observe:** c is gradient and perpendicular to contour lines
- Solution “touches” the polygon



SOLUTIONS TO LP

There are 3 cases for linear programming:

- 1 Feasible set is **empty** $\Rightarrow$ LP is infeasible
- 2 Feasible set is **unbounded**
- 3 Feasible set is **bounded** $\Rightarrow$ LP has at least one solution

